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Date: January 27, 2026
To: School Board
From: Dr. Isaac Cardona, Chief of Schools
Subject: Instructional Minutes Exemptions

2026–27 Instructional Minutes Exemptions

Staff is submitting the recommended **2026–27 School District Calendar** for Board consideration and approval at the February 10, 2026 meeting.

In alignment with the proposed calendar, staff assumes the continuation of current bell schedules and instructional minute frameworks. The proposal also includes three days of parent/teacher conferences as instructional minutes for 2026–27, consistent with historical PPS practice. This approach is also required under the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) collective bargaining agreement, which specifies that instructional minutes and parent-teacher conference days are counted toward meeting state-required instructional time (PAT Contract 6.8.4.5). These elements ensure PPS provides the required instructional time under **OAR 581-022-2320**, barring unforeseeable circumstances:

> (1)(a) Except as allowed under subsections (2) and (4), each school district shall ensure that at least 92% of all students in the district and at least 80% of all students at each school operated by the district are scheduled to receive annually the following minimum hours of instructional time: (A) Grade 12 — 966 hours; (B) Grades 9–11 — 990 hours; and (C) Grades K–8 — 900 hours.

Staff recommends adopting this proposed calendar and approving the allowable exemption also per **581-022-2320 Required Instructional Time (6)(e)** as noted below:

> (6) Upon approval by the local school board, a district may include in its calculation of instructional time required by subsection (1) of this rule the following: ... **(e) Up to 30 hours for parent teacher conferences;**

Recommendation for Exemption 4

Staff further recommends the Board approve **Exemption 4** in alignment with the proposed calendar to ensure district compliance with **OAR 581-022-2320**. This request is specific to the following alternative program:

- **Alliance High School:** To accommodate a four-day instructional week.

Approval of this exemption, in conjunction with the proposed calendar, allows the district to meet all state-mandated instructional time thresholds for the 2026–27 cycle per the following administrative rule:

> (4) A school district may request permission to exempt an alternative education program as defined in ORS 336.615 from the requirement in subsection (1). The request must be made in writing to the Deputy Superintendent of Public Instruction. The Deputy Superintendent is authorized to grant permission under this section without obtaining approval from the State Board of Education. Permission will be granted where: (a) The request is made with the approval of the school district's governing school board; (b) The school district is using an evidence-based strategy that includes flexible time options; and (c) The school district has implemented a system to assess students prior to placement to determine whether placement in an alternative education program is appropriate.

Recommended Action:

- **Approve Exemption (6)(e)** allowing no more than18 hours of parent teacher conferences

- **Approve Required Instructional Time Exemption 4** (for Alliance High School)